50 backlink tactics, ranked S tier to C tier

Run them with Claude + the free SEO skills (github.com/WordRocket/claude-seo-skills). S tier = do these first (best links for the time). C tier = still works, lower return. Every tactic here is white-hat: real sites, real reasons to link. Results vary: your niche, site and follow-up decide yours.

S tier: start here

1. **Unlinked brand mentions.** Sites already talk about you; ask them to add the link. Claude: "Find every site that mentions [brand] without linking to us"
2. **Your competitors' best links.** Find who links to them and why, then give those sites a better reason to link to you. Claude: "Find backlinks my competitors have"
3. **Get cited where Google and AI already look.** Genuinely helpful answers on Reddit, LinkedIn Articles and YouTube for the searches you want. Claude: "Get me on page 1 this week without touching my website"
4. **Original data.** A small survey or your own product numbers, published as a stat page: writers cite stats.
5. **Free tools and calculators.** A useful calculator for your niche earns links for years.
6. **Journalist requests.** Answer reporter queries (Qwoted, Featured, Help a B2B Writer) with a real expert quote, fast.
7. **"Best X" listicles.** Find the roundups in your category and pitch the author with a reason you belong.
8. **Broken link building.** Find dead links on relevant pages and offer your page as the replacement.
9. **Resource pages.** "Useful links" pages in your niche: ask to be added when your page truly fits.
10. **The ultimate guide.** One page that answers a topic better than anything ranking, then promote it to the sites that link to the weaker versions.

A tier: strong, do them next

1. **Guest posts on real sites** your customers read ("write for us" + your niche). Claude: "Find guest post sites in [niche]"
2. **Podcast guesting.** Show notes link back; one interview often leads to the next.
3. **Partner and supplier pages.** Ask the tools, suppliers and partners you already work with to list you.
4. **Testimonials for tools you use.** Many software sites link to customers who give a quote.
5. **Lost links.** Find links that used to point to you (moved or deleted pages) and fix or reclaim them.
6. **Image credits.** Find sites using your images or charts without credit and ask for a source link.

7. **Expert roundups.** Contribute a short, specific answer to "experts share…" posts.
8. **Comparison pages.** "X vs Y" pages that are genuinely fair get linked from forums and reviews.
9. **Local links.** Chamber of commerce, local news, sponsorships, local associations (for local businesses).
10. **Product Hunt / launch sites** for a real launch or new feature.
11. **Case studies with customers.** Publish their result; they link to it from their site.
12. **Glossary and definition pages** for your niche's terms: writers link to clear definitions.
13. **Free templates and checklists** people want to share.
14. **University and nonprofit resource pages** when you have something genuinely educational.
15. **Rewrite your best page into a LinkedIn Article** with a link back to the full version.

B tier: good extras

1. **Industry directories** that real customers use (not link farms).
2. **Review sites** for your category (G2, Capterra, Trustpilot and niche ones).
3. **Conference and meetup speaker pages.**
4. **Scholarships** only if you genuinely run one (no fake ones).
5. **Quora and niche forum answers** with a link only where the rules allow it.
6. **Infographics** with an embed code, when the data is good.
7. **HARO-style newsletters** in your niche: answer reader questions.
8. **Interviews with other creators** that they publish on their site.
9. **Wikipedia citations**, only where your page is a genuinely better source (follow their rules).
10. **Webinars co-hosted with a partner**; both promote the replay page.
11. **"Alternatives to X" pages** being listed on others' roundups.
12. **Awards and certifications** your industry actually recognizes.
13. **Help a writer with a correction** (a better stat, an updated fact) and ask for a source link.
14. **Collaborate on a study** with a complementary brand.
15. **GitHub repos and free skills** that people star and link to (what we did with these skills).

C tier: works, lower return

1. Generic web directories.
2. Blog comments (nofollow; only where you add something useful).
3. Forum signatures.
4. Press releases for small news.
5. Social bookmarking sites.

6. Profile links on random platforms.
7. Mass guest posts on low-quality sites.
8. Link exchanges with unrelated sites.
9. Sponsored posts (must be marked nofollow/sponsored).
10. Waiting for links to come on their own.

Skip these (they can get you penalized)

Buying links that pass ranking value, private blog networks, automated link schemes, mass-uploading pages, decks or PDFs to big sites to borrow their ranking (Google's scaled content abuse and site reputation policies), fake reviews, comment spam.

Free skills: github.com/WordRocket/claude-seo-skills · Write the link-worthy articles with WordRocket (wordrocket.ai), our own tool. Follow each site's rules and Google's spam policies. Results vary.